

Title

Behaviour change intervention during cardiac rehabilitation did not enhance physical activity adherence beyond standard programs at six-month follow-up

Abstract

Objectives: Cardiac rehabilitation programs successfully promote acute increases in physical activity, but durability of these gains remains uncertain. We tested whether augmenting standard rehabilitation with targeted behaviour-change sessions would sustain higher activity levels. **Methods:** Ninety-six patients from six cardiac clinics were cluster-randomized to receive either standard care (usual rehabilitation schedule) or usual rehabilitation plus structured behaviour counselling (6 sessions over 16 weeks). **Primary outcome:** accelerometer-derived moderate-to-vigorous activity minutes and daily steps at 6 months. **Results:** At 6-month assessment, mean daily MVPA was 38 minutes in the standard-care group versus 41 minutes in the behaviour-intervention group (difference 3 minutes; 95% CI -5 to 11 minutes; $p=0.31$). Daily steps were similar (6,892 versus 7,134; $p=0.42$). No between-group differences were observed in self-rated health, quality of life, or mental well-being. **Conclusion:** The behaviour intervention did not produce clinically meaningful improvements beyond standard rehabilitation, possibly because both groups maintained excellent activity levels through ongoing program participation.